

The major sections of Amazon Mechanical Turk:

1. What is Mechanical Turk
2. Set up the accounts and tools for Mechanical Turk
3. Use the Mechanical Turk SDKs to write and publish a Human Intelligence Task (HIT)
4. Implementing Mechanical Turk

What is Mechanical Turk?

Amazon Mechanical Turk software formalises job offers to the thousands of Workers willing to do work at their convenience. The software also retrieves work performed and compiles it for you, the Requester, who pays the Workers for satisfactory work (only). Optional qualification tests enable you to select competent Workers.

The kinds of tasks humans can complete better than computers include finding objects in photos, writing reviews of restaurants, movies, or businesses, translating text passages into foreign languages, getting the hours of operation of the business centre within a hotel, determining if a hotel is family-friendly, or telling you the most relevant search results.

Salient features:

1. On-demand workforce—Amazon Mechanical Turk provides access to a virtual community of Workers.
2. Create jobs that Workers perform over the Internet—Advertise your job to the thousands of Amazon Mechanical Turk Workers around the world
3. Test and publish your jobs—Test your jobs in the Amazon Mechanical Turk sandbox and publish the revised jobs to the outside world.

Amazon Mechanical Turk Concepts:

Requester

A Requester is a company, organisation, or person that creates and submits tasks (HITs) to Amazon Mechanical Turk for Workers to perform.

Human Intelligence Task

A (HIT) is a task that a Requester submits to Amazon Mechanical Turk for Workers to perform. Each HIT has a lifetime, specified by the Requester, that determines how long the HIT is available to Workers. A HIT also has an assignment duration, which is the amount of time a Worker has to complete a HIT after accepting it.